



PARTNERS *of the* AMERICAS
Connect • Serve • Change Lives



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IT Acceptable Use Policy

Effective December 1st, 2023

Enacted

John McPhail
President & CEO

Table of Contents

1. Objective	3
2. Definitions.....	3
3. Scope.....	3
4. Policy	4
4.1 General Use and Ownership	4
4.2 Security and Proprietary Information	4
4.3 Unacceptable Use.....	5
4.3.1 System and Network Activities	5
4.3.2 Email and Communication Activities.....	6
4.3.3 Blogging and Social Media	6
6. Exceptions to the Policy	7
7. Compliance Audits	7
8. Reporting Violations.....	7

1. Objective

The purpose of this policy is to outline the acceptable use of computer equipment and other electronic devices at Partners of the Americas Inc. (Partners). These rules are in place to protect the employee and Partners. Inappropriate use exposes Partners to cyber risks including virus attacks including ransomware, compromise of network systems and services, data breach, and legal issues. Effective security is a team effort involving the participation and support of every Partners employee and affiliate who deals with information and/or information systems. It is the responsibility of every computer user to know these guidelines, and to conduct their activities accordingly.

2. Definitions

1. **FSI Strategies** – is the IT company that Partners has contracted to assist and manage Partners devices, IT equipment, and SharePoint.
1. **Honeypots** - Programs that simulate one or more network services that you designate on your computer's ports. An attacker assumes you are running vulnerable services that can be used to break into the machine. A honey pot can be used to log access attempts to those ports including the attacker's keystrokes. This could give you advanced warning of a more concerted attack.
2. **Honeymonkeys** - Automated system simulating a user browsing websites. The system is typically configured to detect web sites which exploit vulnerabilities in the browser. Also known as Honey Client.
3. **Proprietary Information** - Proprietary information is that information unique to a company and its ability to compete, such as customer lists, technical data, product costs, and trade secrets.
4. **Spam** - Electronic junk mail or junk newsgroup postings.
5. **Ransomware** - A type of malware that is a form of extortion. It works by encrypting a victim's hard drive denying them access to key files. The victim must then pay a ransom to decrypt the files and gain access to them again.

3. Scope

This policy applies to the use of information, electronic and computing devices, and network resources to conduct Partners business or interact with internal networks and business systems, whether owned or leased by Partners, the employee, or a third party. All employees, contractors, consultants, volunteers, and others at Partners are responsible for exercising good judgment



regarding appropriate use of information, electronic devices, and network resources in accordance with Partners policies and standards, and local laws and regulation.

4. Policy

Partners expects that all Partners staff, consultants, volunteers, and affiliates adhered to the following guidance.

4.1 General Use and Ownership

1. Partners proprietary information stored on electronic and computing devices whether owned or leased by Partners, the employee or a third party, remains the sole property of Partners. You must ensure through legal or technical means that proprietary information is protected.
2. You have a responsibility to promptly report the theft, loss, or unauthorized disclosure of Partners proprietary information to the Chief Operating Officer (COO) using the [IT Security Incident Report](#).
3. You may access, use, or share Partners proprietary information only to the extent it is authorized and necessary to fulfill your assigned job duties.
4. For security and network maintenance purposes, authorized individuals within Partners or through FSI Strategies may monitor equipment, systems, and network traffic at any time.
5. Partners and FSI Strategies reserves the right to audit networks and systems on a periodic basis to ensure compliance with this policy.

4.2 Security and Proprietary Information

1. System level and user level passwords must comply with the [Password Protection Policy](#). Providing access to another individual, either deliberately or through failure to secure its access, is prohibited.
2. All computing devices must be secured with a password-protected lock screen with the automatic activation feature set to 10 minutes or less. You must lock the screen or log off when the device is unattended.
3. Postings by employees from a Partners email address to newsgroups or other online platforms, should contain a disclaimer stating that the opinions expressed are strictly their own and not necessarily those of Partners, unless posting is related to business duties.
4. Employees must use extreme caution when opening email attachments received from unknown senders, which may contain malware. If there is any doubt to the validity of



an email, the user should contact the COO or FSI Strategies at support@fsistrategies.com.

4.3 Unacceptable Use

The following activities are, in general, prohibited. Employees may be exempted from these restrictions during their legitimate job responsibilities (e.g., systems administration staff may have a need to disable the network access of a host if that host is disrupting production services).

Under no circumstances is an employee of Partners authorized to engage in any activity that is illegal under local, state, federal or international law while utilizing Partners owned resources. When using Partners resources to access and use the Internet, users must realize they represent the Partners and their conduct must be in compliance with this policy and [Partners Code of Conduct](#) in the Employee Handbook. The lists below are by no means exhaustive but attempt to provide a framework for activities which fall into the category of unacceptable use.

4.3.1 System and Network Activities

1. Violations of the rights of any person or company protected by copyright, trade secret, patent or other intellectual property, or similar laws or regulations, including, but not limited to, the installation or distribution of "pirated" or other software products that are not appropriately licensed for use by Partners.
2. Unauthorized copying of copyrighted material including, but not limited to, digitization and distribution of photographs from magazines, books or other copyrighted sources, copyrighted music, and the installation of any copyrighted software for which Partners or the end user does not have an active license is strictly prohibited.
3. Accessing data, a server, or an account for any purpose other than conducting Partners is prohibited.
4. Exporting software, technical information, encryption software or technology, in violation of international or regional export control laws, is illegal. The COO should be consulted prior to export of any material that is in question.
5. Introduction of malicious programs into the network or server (e.g., viruses, worms, trojan horses, ransomware, etc.).
6. Revealing your account password/passphrase to others or allowing use of your account by others. This includes family and other household members when work is being done at home.
7. Using a Partners computing asset(s) to actively engage in procuring or transmitting material that is in violation of [sexual harassment or hostile workplace policy](#) at Partners.



8. Making fraudulent offers of products, items, or services originating from any Partners account.
9. Creating or affecting security breaches or disruptions of network communication.
 - a. Security breaches include, but are not limited to, accessing data of which the employee is not an intended recipient or logging into a server or account that the employee is not authorized to access, unless these duties are within the scope of regular duties.
 - b. Disruptions includes, but is not limited to, network sniffing, ping floods, packet spoofing, denial of service, and forged routing information for malicious purposes.
10. Executing any form of network monitoring which will intercept data not intended for the employee's host unless this activity is a part of the employee's normal job/duty.
11. Circumventing user authentication or security of any host, network, or account.
12. Introducing honeypots, honeymonkeys, or similar technology on the Partners network.
13. Using any program/script/command, or sending messages of any kind, with the intent to interfere with, or disable, a user's session, via any means, locally or via the Internet/SharePoint.
14. Providing information about, or lists of, Partners employees to parties outside Partners, unless authorized as part of normal job duties.

4.3.2 Email and Communication Activities

1. Sending unsolicited email messages, including the sending of "junk mail" or other advertising material to individuals who did not specifically request such material (email spam).
2. Any form of harassment via email, telephone, or text, whether through language, frequency, or size of messages. See [Partners Anti-Harassment Policy](#).
3. Unauthorized use, or forging, of email header information.
4. Creating or forwarding "chain letters", "Ponzi" or other "pyramid" schemes of any type.
5. Posting the same or similar non-business-related messages to large numbers of Partners users (group spam).

4.3.3 Blogging and Social Media

1. Blogging or posting to social media platforms by employees, whether using Partners' property and systems or personal computer systems, is also subject to the terms and restrictions set forth in this Policy. Limited and occasional use of Partners' systems to engage in blogging or other online social media posting is acceptable, provided that it is done in a professional and responsible manner, does not otherwise violate Partners'



- policy, is not detrimental to Partners' best interests, and does not interfere with an employee's regular work duties.
2. [Partners Statement of Confidentiality](#) also applies to blogging and social media posts. As such, Employees are prohibited from revealing any Partners confidential or proprietary information, trade secrets or any other material covered by Partners' Statement of Confidentiality.
 3. Employees shall not engage in any blogging or social media post that may harm or tarnish the image, reputation and/or goodwill of Partners and/or any of its employees. Employees are also prohibited from making any discriminatory, disparaging, defamatory or harassing comments or otherwise engaging in any conduct prohibited by Partners' [Non-Discrimination Policy](#) and [Anti-Harassment Policy](#).
 4. Employees may also not attribute personal statements, opinions or beliefs to Partners when engaged in blogging or social media posts. If an employee is expressing his or her beliefs and/or opinions, the employee may not, expressly, or implicitly, represent themselves as an employee or representative of Partners.
 5. Apart from following all laws pertaining to the handling and disclosure of copyrighted or export-controlled materials, Partners' trademarks, logos, and any other Partners' intellectual property may also not be used in connection with any blogging or social media activity.

6. Exceptions to the Policy

Any exception to the above policy must be approved via email in advance by the COO.

7. Compliance Audits

Partners and FSI Strategies reserve the right to conduct internal audits to determine if any violations of this policy exist.

8. Reporting Violations

If any violations of this policy must reported to the COO. The COO review the violation and determine the best course of action to resolve the issue of non-compliance. This may include disciplinary actions and involvement of Human Resources.